NHMEC

Community Herbalist Diploma

Level II – Applied Studies

MODULE 15

Applied Community Herbal Practicum

Module Overview

Knowledge becomes wisdom through application.

Throughout this diploma, you have studied herbal preparations, stewardship, teaching methods, community gardens, nutrition, outreach, ethics, leadership, and professional development. This practicum provides the opportunity to put those skills into practice through meaningful community service and educational outreach.

The Applied Community Herbal Practicum is not intended to prepare students for clinical practice or the treatment of disease. Instead, it demonstrates competency in **community herbal education**, **leadership**, **organization**, and **public service**.

Students will complete supervised or self-directed educational projects that benefit their local communities while documenting their experiences in a professional practicum portfolio.

Module Objectives

Upon successful completion of this module, students will be able to:

• Demonstrate competency in community herbal education.

• Apply leadership and organizational skills.

• Plan and implement community outreach activities.

• Document volunteer service professionally.

• Evaluate educational outcomes.

• Reflect upon personal and professional growth.

• Prepare evidence of competency for the final portfolio.

Required Reading

Review the **Community Herbalist eGuide** in its entirety, paying special attention to sections covering:

• Community Education

• Outreach

• Stewardship

• Herbal Preparations

• Leadership

• Ethics

• Community Service

Review your notes, journals, herb monographs, preparation records, and previous assignments as you prepare for your practicum.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this module, students will demonstrate the ability to organize, teach, and evaluate community herbal education activities while maintaining professional standards and an educational scope of practice.

Instructor Lecture

Learning Through Service

The purpose of community herbalism is not simply to accumulate knowledge—it is to serve.

Service transforms information into experience.

When Community Herbalists teach others, plant gardens, organize workshops, or volunteer within their communities, they strengthen both their own understanding and the well-being of those they serve.

This practicum emphasizes:

Education

Stewardship

Leadership

Compassion

Professionalism

Service

Practicum Expectations

Students are expected to complete **15–20 documented practicum hours**.

Hours may be completed through one project or several smaller projects.

Activities should focus on education, stewardship, outreach, or community service.

Approved Practicum Activities

Examples include:

Teaching a beginner herbal class

Leading a medicinal herb walk

Presenting at a church wellness ministry

Organizing a community garden workday

Hosting a seed exchange

Conducting a culinary herb demonstration

Presenting at a library

Teaching a homeschool group

Developing educational displays for a farmers market

Creating educational herb identification materials

Building a pollinator garden

Developing herb garden signage

Assisting with a community wellness event

Creating educational videos or presentations

Writing educational articles for community newsletters

Students may propose additional projects with instructor approval.

Planning Your Practicum

Before beginning:

Define your objectives.

Identify your audience.

Determine needed supplies.

Develop a timeline.

Create educational materials.

Prepare evaluation forms.

Document your planning.

Good preparation leads to successful outcomes.

Documenting Your Experience

Maintain detailed records including:

Dates

Hours

Locations

Activities

Objectives

Participant numbers

Photographs

Lesson plans

Volunteer logs

Challenges encountered

Solutions implemented

Personal reflections

Documentation demonstrates professionalism and accountability.

Evaluating Success

Following each activity, ask:

Did I meet my objectives?

What did participants learn?

What questions were asked?

What could be improved?

Would I organize this activity again?

Evaluation strengthens future educational efforts.

Professional Conduct

Throughout the practicum:

Dress appropriately.

Communicate respectfully.

Arrive prepared.

Maintain professional boundaries.

Respect confidentiality.

Represent herbal education accurately.

Serve with humility and integrity.

Your character reflects your professionalism.

Biblical Reflection

James 2:17 (KJV)

"Even so faith, if it hath not works, is dead, being alone."

Knowledge without action accomplishes little. Community Herbalists demonstrate their commitment through faithful service, practical education, and compassionate leadership within their communities.

Vocabulary

Define:

Practicum

Competency

Volunteer Service

Educational Outreach

Facilitation

Community Engagement

Evaluation

Reflection

Professional Conduct

Portfolio Evidence

Reflection Questions

1. Which practicum activity are you most excited to complete?
2. What challenges do you anticipate?
3. How has this diploma prepared you for community service?

4. Which skills have improved the most?
5. How will you evaluate the success of your practicum?
6. What did you learn about yourself during this experience?
7. How has serving others strengthened your understanding of community herbalism?

Practicum Activity Log

Complete a log documenting at least **15–20 hours**.

Include:

Date

Activity

Location

Hours

Audience

Learning Objectives

Materials Used

Outcome

Instructor Verification (if applicable)

Practical Assignment

Community Herbal Education Event

Plan and conduct one educational event lasting at least **60 minutes**.

Possible topics include:

Introduction to Community Herbalism

Kitchen Herbalism

Medicinal Herb Gardening

Herbal Teas

Seasonal Herbal Wellness

Culinary Herbs

Herbal Preparedness

Pollinator Gardens

Include:

Lesson Plan

Participant Handouts

Attendance Sheet

Evaluation Form

Photographs (if permitted)

Reflection

Assignment

Applied Practicum Report

Prepare a professional report including:

Introduction

Objectives

Project Description

Timeline

Educational Materials

Photographs

Volunteer Documentation

Participant Feedback

Challenges

Solutions

Personal Reflection

Future Recommendations

Minimum Length:

15–20 pages.

Mini Quiz

1. The primary purpose of the practicum is to:

A. Memorize plant names

B. Apply community herbal education skills through service

C. Diagnose illness

D. Replace classroom instruction

2. Practicum documentation should include:

A. Hours and activities

B. Objectives and reflections

C. Participant feedback

D. All of the above

3. Professional conduct includes:

A. Respect and preparation

B. Making exaggerated claims

C. Ignoring participants

D. Working without planning

4. Evaluation helps:

A. Improve future educational programs

B. Eliminate planning

C. Replace documentation

D. Reduce learning

5. Community Herbalists demonstrate competency through:

A. Practical application of knowledge

B. Memorizing only

C. Advertising

D. Competition

Answer Key

1. B
2. D
3. A
4. A
5. A

Module Project

Community Herbal Practicum Portfolio

Assemble documentation from your practicum experience.

Include:

Practicum Agreement (if applicable)

Activity Log

Volunteer Hour Verification

Lesson Plans

Educational Handouts

Workshop Materials

Garden Plans

Photographs

Participant Evaluations

Community Partnerships

Media or Promotional Materials

Personal Reflection

Professional Growth Summary

Recommendations for Future Projects

This portfolio should demonstrate your ability to organize, teach, and lead community herbal education activities with professionalism and integrity.

Community Herbal Journal

Write a comprehensive reflection on your practicum.

Include:

• Five lessons learned through service.

• Three unexpected challenges.

• Two ways your confidence has grown.

• One area where you still hope to improve.

• Your vision for continuing community herbal education after graduation.

Module Completion Checklist

☐ Required reading reviewed

☐ Vocabulary completed

☐ Reflection questions answered

☐ 15–20 practicum hours completed

☐ Educational event conducted

☐ Practicum Activity Log completed

☐ Practicum Report submitted

☐ Practicum Portfolio assembled

☐ Quiz passed (80% or higher)

☐ Community Herbal Journal completed

Instructor Challenge (Optional)

Expand your practicum by organizing a **Community Herbal Education Day** featuring multiple educational stations, such as:

• Herb Identification

• Herbal Tea Tasting

• Culinary Herb Demonstrations

• Medicinal Garden Tours

• Pollinator Education

• Children's Nature Activities

• Herbal Preparation Demonstrations

Invite community partners, collect participant feedback, and document the event for inclusion in your final Community Herbalist Portfolio.

Looking Ahead

In **Module 16**, you will complete the **Community Herbalist Capstone Portfolio and Final Comprehensive Examination**. You will assemble the work completed throughout the diploma into a professional portfolio, reflect on your growth as a Community Herbalist, and demonstrate your competency through a 100-question open-book final examination. Successful completion of Module 16 fulfills the requirements for the **NHMEC Community Herbalist Diploma – Level II Applied Studies**.